

MARCH 16-31, 1980

have become paranoid about India becoming hegemonic in South Asia. With India's neighbours upping the ante out of sheer jealousy, it seems unfair to blame Manmohan Singh's foreign policy for the diplomatic falling out with countries like China and Pakistan.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

Course of the Law

Ruchika Girhotra's case has highlighted the need for prompt dispensation of justice as well as the protection of victims and key witnesses ("Feeble Justice", January 4). More importantly, it underlines the necessity of drafting legal provisions to treat child abuse as a special case so that offenders can be punished severely. The editorial is right in saying that in India the establishment will go to any lengths to protect a political favourite. As long as this practice continues, tragedies such as Girhotra's will recur.

PRABHJOT KAUR,
via www.indiatoday.in

Saving the Planet

Hopes for a better tomorrow were dashed at Copenhagen ("The Earth in ICU", January 4). Melting glaciers, rising sea levels, pollution by fossil fuels and deforestation are aggravating global warming. Unexplained cyclones are taking a

heavy toll of human lives. In this context, it is disconcerting that leaders at Copenhagen failed to reach an agreement on emission cuts to reduce global warming.

KANGAYAM R. NARASIMHAN,
Chennai

Real Success

Kaveree Bamzai has aptly summarised the problem of moral degeneration in youth ("How Not to Succeed",

Growth Factor

Course correction is within the realm of controlling threat factors ("Political Threat to Growth", December 21). While the 7.9 per cent GDP growth in the second quarter is a good news, the rise in food prices remains almost the single most threatening factor. Therefore, raising interest rates is inevitable as the economy moves to a higher trajectory from the slowdown phase, and in-



“ Past life regression may be useful for medical purposes but it does not quite make for a reality show. Many people are weak mentally and may not come to terms with the findings easily. ”

M. KUMAR, via www.indiatoday.in

December 28). As mentioned by her, Tiger Woods may be a sporting icon but can never be a role model for our children. It's important for young people to choose their role models carefully and parents play an important role here.

ANKESH KUMAR,
via www.indiatoday.in

terest factor is one of the many considerations for further investment. Economic indicators reveal that it is advisable to start monetary and fiscal tightening from the turn of the year, else vested interests will dissuade withdrawal of the concessions.

K.U. MADA,
Mumbai

A Rural Time Bomb

If Mao was alive, he would smile benignly at the wanton violence which has gripped rural India, where 80 per cent of the country's population lives. For him the reports of rural violence would have read not like a chronology of death and destruction but the sparking of a rural revolution which is long overdue in India. No less than 10 savage incidents have made front page headlines since last December, involving 42 deaths in Uttar Pradesh and Bihar alone. Fourteen Harijans were shot dead at Jauharpur in Uttar Pradesh on December 11. A month later a group of policemen indulged in a mass orgy of rape and plunder, killing two Harijans at Narainpur in Uttar Pradesh. In neighbouring Bihar, 12 members of a backward caste were shot dead at night at Parasbigha. Twenty-one days later, 14 Harijans were butchered by a 500-strong gang of armed men at Pipra, and on March 16, Harijan houses were set on fire at Katni.

by Arul B. Louis with Prabhu Chawla in New Delhi



RURAL VIOLENCE AT AN ALL-TIME HIGH

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